

MATCH

in

HAND

10+

2-4

20'

Toasted
JUSTICE LEAGUE

MATCH IN HAND is a fast-paced tactical football card battler.
Set up your team, play cards to score goals, and beat your opponent!



COMPONENTS - 93 CARDS



22x Player/Goal cards



1x Half-Time card



21x Attack Action cards



20x Midfield Action cards



19x Defense Action cards



10x Management cards

CARD TYPES

- There are 4 types of cards:
 - Player/Goal cards
 - Action cards
 - Management cards
 - Half-Time card
- Player cards allow you to set up the **Team Formation**. The different colors distinguish the **Home** team from the **Away** team.
- Goal cards keep count of goals scored by each player.
- Action cards are categorised in 3 sub-types:
 - Attack [Orange]
 - Midfield [Green]
 - Defense [Blue]
- Management [Grey] cards are used during the game, but are **kept aside** and are not part of the player's hand.
- The **Half-Time** card is used to indicate when half-time is reached during the game.



SETUP

- Shuffle all the 60 Action cards [Orange, Green, Blue] and distribute 5 to each player, face down. Players can look at their hand.
- Place the remaining Action cards as a **Draw pile**, face down, at the center of the play area.
- Insert the **Half-Time** card in the middle of the Draw pile.
- Distribute a set of **Management** [Grey] cards to each player, including: 2x Substitution, 1x Formation Switch, 1x VAR Goal Check, 1x Out of Position.
- Distribute 5x Home Player cards to one player and 5x Away Player cards to the other. Then, define the **Team Formations** as explained in the section below.
- Flip the remaining Player cards, and place them as **Goal cards** in another pile, close to the center of the play area.
- The player with the **Home Team** starts. Alternatively, you can decide who goes first by tossing a coin.
- Start the game, play in turns and score goals!

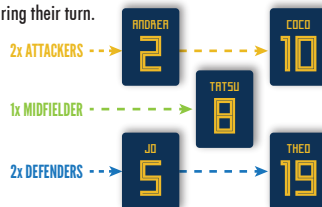


CARD USAGE

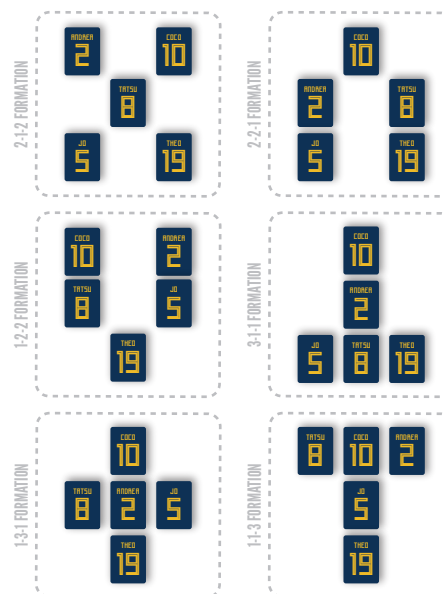
- Player cards remain on the table during the entire game.
- Action cards are placed on top of Player cards when used during a turn.
- Management cards are used anytime during the game, without placing them on top of Player cards.
- Action cards can be combined to generate more powerful attacks, defenses and other tactical maneuvers. For instance:
 - +2 Attack + 1 Attack = 3 Attack
 - +1 Defense + 2 Defense = 3 Defense
- Action and Management cards are consumed once used. At the end of the turn, move them face up to the **Discard pile**.

TEAM FORMATION

- To define a starting **Team Formation**, 5 Player cards are allocated between **Defense** [Blue], **Midfield** [Green] and **Attack** [Orange] positions.
- A player's **Team Formation** determines which Action cards can be played at any given moment.
- Example:
 - A 2-1-2 Team Formation (2x Defenders, 1x Midfielder, 2x Attackers) allows a player to use up to two Defense Action cards, one Midfield Action card and two Attack Action cards during their turn.
- The starting **Team Formation** needs to have at least one **Player in each position**. Once the match is started, this restriction is removed when using **Management** cards.



FORMATION EXAMPLES



HOW TO PLAY

I. GAME STRUCTURE & TURNS

- The game is played in two halves, the **First Half** and the **Second Half**, known as **Regular Time**.

- Each player plays in turn, which consists in two actions:

- Pick the top card from the Draw pile



- Play one card or more **OR** Play nothing and pick a second card from the Draw pile.



- Some cards allow to **attack and/or defend**, some allow to **react to the opponent's actions**, while others are **combined** to create powerful effects.

! Instant cards can be played whenever an opponent plays a card (unless stated otherwise). They are marked with the **!** icon.

- The **Penalty!** card can be played right after the opponent **successfully defends** or plays a **Tactical Foul** card, and before playing any additional card.
- The **Tactical Foul** card can be played right before the opponent plays a **Counter-Attack** card, if they defended with some +Defense card(s).

- A player can **only initiate an attack during their own turn**. Doing so starts an **Attack-Defense phase**.
- At the end of a turn, all the **cards played during a turn are discarded** and moved to the Discard pile, face up.
- A player **cannot end their turn with more than 7 cards** in their hand. They **must discard any excess cards** before ending the turn.

II. ATTACK-DEFENSE PHASE

- To score a goal, a player needs to attack their opponent by playing one or more **+ATTACK Action card(s)** during their turn.

The attacking player's turn lasts until the **Attack-Defense phase is resolved**. Cards played by the defending opponent during this phase are also part of the same turn.



- Once an attack has been initiated, players cannot add more **+ATTACK** cards to increase its initial value, or to trigger a second attack.

- To defend successfully, the **opponent must use +DEFENSE** cards from their hand that match the **+ATTACK** value. Some cards can also reduce that **+ATTACK** value. The defender can also choose to concede the goal without using any cards, as part of their tactical play.

- Various outcomes can occur during an Attack-Defense phase:

- The opponent **cannot defend** successfully and the attacking player **scores a goal!**
- The opponent **defends successfully** and **no other card is played** from either side.
- The opponent **defends and triggers a counter-attack**, forcing the attacking player to now defend. This **back-and-forth** can continue for as long as cards can be played.



- An **Attack-Defense phase** keeps on until:

- A goal is scored.
- Both players reach a **stalemate**.

- If a goal is scored during the Attack-Defense phase, the player conceding the goal **starts the next turn and picks two cards** instead of one.

III. END OF THE FIRST HALF

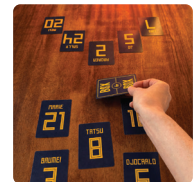
- Players play in turns until the **Half-Time card** is revealed as the **top card on the Draw pile**.
- From there, **players cannot pick or draw cards** from the Draw Pile until the end of the First Half.
- After completing the turn in which the Half-Time card is revealed, **one last turn is played before ending the First Half**.
- Discard** the Half-Time card from the Draw Pile to start the Half-Time break.

IV. HALF-TIME BREAK

- During the **Half-Time break**, each player can:
 - Modify** their entire **Team Formation** for free, without any restrictions.
 - Restock their hand up to 5 Action cards**, by picking cards from the Draw pile. This action cannot be done if a player has already 5 or more cards in their hand.
- The Half-Time break ends when all players are ready.

IV. SECOND HALF & END OF REGULAR TIME

- The player who **didn't start the First Half** starts the Second Half.
- The **Second Half** lasts until the **Draw pile is depleted**.



- Once completing the turn in which the last card is drawn, **one final turn is played before ending the Second Half**, thus also ending **Regular Time**.

The player who scored the most goals wins the game!

- If **Regular Time** ends in a tie, players can decide the game by:
 - Ending the game in a **Draw**.
 - Playing **Extra Time**. If it also ends in a Draw, proceed to the **Penalty Shoot-Out**.
 - Directly playing the **Penalty Shoot-Out**.

EXTRA TIME & PENALTY SHOOT-OUT

- Extra Time** is played just like during Regular Time, but with a **halved Draw Pile**:
 - Reshuffle all the Action cards and set up the game as usual. Split the Draw Pile in two stacks; insert the Half-Time card in one stack, and discard the other one.
 - Management** cards do not get redistributed, each player keeps the one(s) they haven't used during Regular Time.
 - The player who started Regular Time starts the First Half of Extra Time.
- To play the **Penalty Shoot-Out**:
 - Distribute **2x Goal Chance** and **1x Miraculous Save** cards to each player. Each player lines up the 3 cards in front of them, face down.
 - Then, the opponent chooses one card to reveal. If the **Miraculous Save** card is revealed, the **penalty is saved**. Otherwise, the opponent scores.
 - Repeat in turns until each player has taken **5 penalties**. The player who has scored the most penalties wins the game! If the score is still level, continue the shoot-out in sudden death until one player wins.

4-PLAYER VARIANT

- You can play a **team-based variant** with 2 players in each team. To do so, play a game as usual, with the updated setup.
 - Players **start with 3 cards each** (instead of 5), and the hand size is limited to **5 cards max** (instead of 7).
 - Management** cards are **shared** by both players on a team.
- During a turn, **both players in a team play together**:
 - Both players draw a card at the start of their turn. They play cards, or choose not to, as a team. If one player plays cards, the teammate is also considered to be playing, even if they play no cards.
 - Players play all their card(s) at once, one after the other. The same applies when players are defending. There are no rules as to which player on a team plays first.
 - If the team chooses to play nothing, both players pick a card at the end of their turn.
 - If a team concedes a goal, both players pick 2 cards each.
- Players **cannot communicate the content of their hand** to their teammate. They can only communicate their intentions. You can say "I can defend", not "I have a Miraculous Save card".

FAQ

- Midfield Action cards can be played while attacking or defending, but not both at the same time. Players choose in which role the card is used when they play it.
- Counter-Attacks can be boosted by the **Overlap** card, but not by adding **+ATTACK** cards. After a **Counter-Attack** card is played, the Defense cards previously played can no longer be negated. Opponents can prevent a counter-attack if an Instant card is played right before.
- The effects of the **Overlap** and **Out of Position** cards do not apply retroactively on cards that have already been used. They only combine with cards that they are played with.
- When a player uses the **Tactical Foul** card to negate an attack, the opponent cannot add more Attack Action cards. On the contrary, if it is used to negate a defense, the opponent can still defend. Moreover, the **Tactical Foul** card cannot negate the effect of a card that has already been used during a turn.